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# Git Reflog

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## What is Git Reflog?

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`git reflog` records updates to the tip of branches and HEAD.

It lets you see where your branch and HEAD have been, even changes you made by mistake.

This is useful for recovering lost commits or undoing a reset.

## When to Use Git Reflog

Use `git reflog` when you need to:

- Recover lost commits or changes
- Undo a reset or a merge
- See the history of your branch and HEAD

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## Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git reflog
e56ba1f (HEAD -> master) HEAD@{0}: commit: Revert "Just
52418f7 HEAD@{1}: commit: Just a regular update, defini
9a9add8 (origin/master) HEAD@{2}: commit: Added .gitigr
81912ba HEAD@{3}: commit: Corrected spelling error
3fdaa5b HEAD@{4}: merge: Merge pull request #1 from w3s
836e5bf HEAD@{5}: commit: Updated readme for GitHub Bra
...
```

This lists recent positions of HEAD, so you can see actions like commits, resets, merges, and checkouts.

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# Find and Recover Lost Commits

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### Example: Undo a Hard Reset

```
[user@localhost] $ git reflog
e56ba1f (HEAD -> master) HEAD@{0}: commit: Revert "Just
52418f7 HEAD@{1}: commit: Just a regular update, defini
9a9add8 (origin/master) HEAD@{2}: commit: Added .gitigr
81912ba HEAD@{3}: commit: Corrected spelling error
...
[user@localhost] $ git reset --hard HEAD@{2}
HEAD is now at 9a9add8 Added .gitignore
```

This puts your branch back to the state it was in at that point.

## Clean Up the Reflog

The reflog is automatically cleaned by Git, but you can manually expire old entries if needed:

### Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git reflog expire --expire=30.days refs/heads/main
[user@localhost] $ git gc --prune=now
Counting objects: 15, done.
Compressing objects: 100% (10/10), done.
Pruning objects
```

This removes reflog entries older than 30 days for the `main` branch and runs garbage collection.

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- Use `git reflog` to recover lost commits or changes
- Use `git reflog expire` to clean up old entries

## Troubleshooting

If you encounter issues with `git reflog`, try:

- Checking the Git documentation for more information
- Searching online for solutions to specific issues
- Seeking help from a Git expert or community

## Warnings

Be careful when using `git reflog` to recover lost commits or changes, as it can overwrite existing changes.

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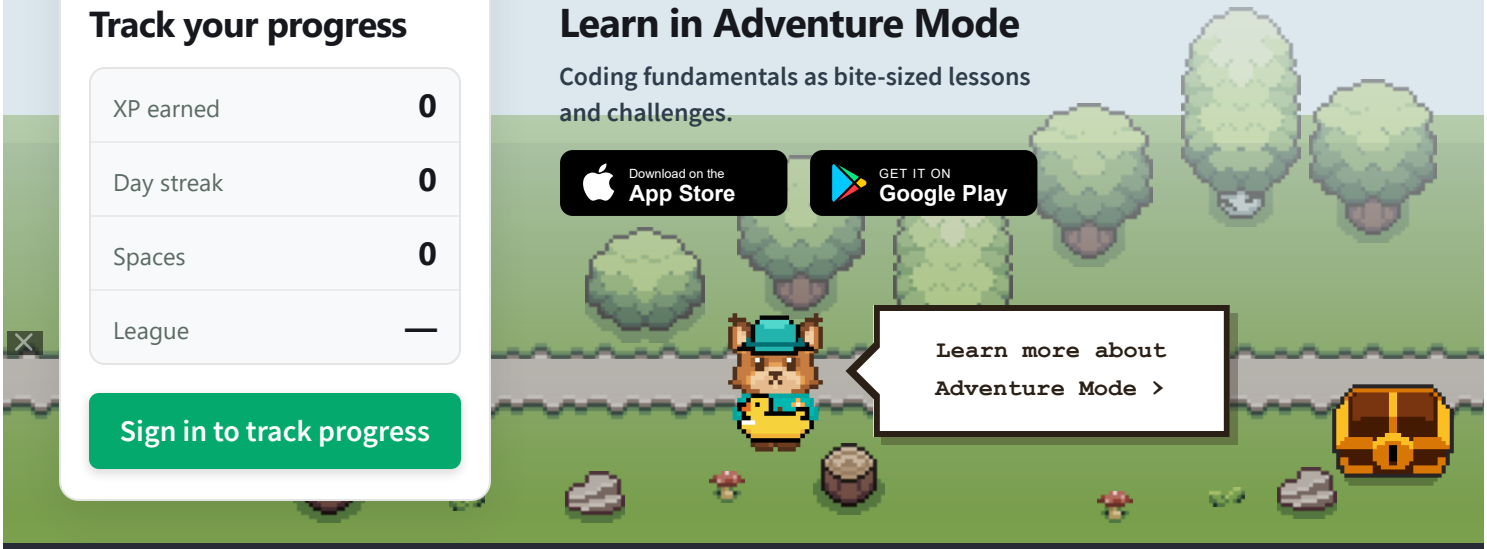
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